

T01 — Engagement Request and Qualification

Used in **Phase 0**. Completed by the Red Team Lead with the requesting customer. Ends with an accept/decline decision at Gate G0.

Field	Value
Request reference	RT-REQ-[YYYY]-[NNN]
Date received	
Requested by (name, role)	
Target organisation / division	
Requested timeframe	
Red Team Lead assessing	

1. The ask

1.1 What is being requested, in the customer's words?

Response / notes

1.2 What decision will the customer make with the result?

If this cannot be answered, there is no engagement. Stop here.

Response / notes

1.3 What prompted the request now? *(New system, incident, audit finding, regulatory pressure, leadership request, scheduled cycle)*

Response / notes

2. Mission / business context

2.1 Which mission or business service is at risk? *Start from the service, not the systems.*

Response / notes

2.2 What does failure of that service look like? *Operational, financial, safety, reputational, mission impact.*

Response / notes

2.3 Which systems, identities, data and suppliers support that service?

Type	Identifier	Owner
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2.4 What must absolutely not be disrupted, and during which periods?

Response / notes

Response / notes

3. Instrument selection

3.1 What does the customer actually need?

If they want...	Deliver...	✓
A list of weaknesses across an estate	Vulnerability assessment — refer elsewhere	☐
Proof a specific system can be broken	Penetration test	☐
To know whether their detections work	Purple team exercise (SL-4)	☐
To know whether a realistic attack achieves impact undetected	Red team engagement (SL-1 / SL-2)	☐
To train their team under pressure	Exercise red team (SL-3)	☐
Regulatory or audit assurance	Threat-led test with formal attestation	☐

3.2 Selected instrument and rationale:

Response / notes

4. Minimum defensibility baseline

See the Red Team Methodology, paragraph 4.5. Applies to SL-1 and SL-2.

#	Condition	Met?	Evidence / note
1	Centralised log collection exists for endpoints and identity	☐	
2	Someone reviews alerts, with defined hours	☐	

#	Condition	Met?	Evidence / note
3	An incident response process exists on paper	☐	
4	Asset ownership is known well enough to route a finding	☐	
5	A previous assessment has been remediated	☐	

Conditions unmet: _____ / 5

Three or more unmet to recommend a purple team exercise or tabletop instead, in writing.

5. Draft objectives

Maximum three. Specific and verifiable. See Annex D, paragraph D.5.

Objective ID	Draft objective	Category (Protect/Detect/Respond/Restore)
O-01		
O-02		
O-03		

6. Governance readiness

Question	Answer
Which legal entity owns each system, identity, facility and dataset proposed for scope?	
Who holds actual System Authority and can consent to access?	
Who can accept operational risk as Approving Authority?	
Are authority and risk acceptance held separately?	☐ Yes ☐ No — if yes, both are required
Is any authority holder part of the function assessed, and how will outcome independence be protected?	
Who will be the Trusted Agent?	
Is the candidate outside both the red team and the defensive element?	☐ Yes ☐ No

Question	Answer
Who must not know this is happening, and why?	
Are hosted, third-party or supplier services a source, target or dependency?	☐ Yes ☐ No — list providers and direct permissions required:
Is any regulated, classified, or safety-critical system in scope?	☐ Yes ☐ No
Which legal, privacy, regulatory, contractual or provider reviews are required?	
Who will own the fixes, and do they have capacity?	

7. Initial risk and effort assessment

Factor	Assessment
Operational risk to production	☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High
Legal complexity	☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High
Data sensitivity in scope	☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High
Estimated execution duration	
Estimated total elapsed duration	
Team capacity available	☐ Yes ☐ No — conflicts:
Skills gap	
External reviewer or specialist required	☐ Yes ☐ No — reason:

8. Gate G0 decision

Decided by the Head of Red Team.

#	Criterion	✓
1	A named mission or business service is identified	☐
2	The customer can state the decision the result will inform	☐
3	Red teaming is the correct instrument	☐

#	Criterion	✓
4	Defensibility baseline met, or an alternative proposed	☐
5	A candidate Approving Authority with sufficient authority exists	☐
6	A candidate System Authority can positively authorise the proposed target space	☐
7	Required third-party and provider permissions can be obtained	☐
8	The team has capacity, separation and skills, or a plan to obtain them	☐

Decision: ☐ Accept ☐ Accept with conditions ☐ Decline — alternative recommended

Conditions / alternative recommended:

Response / notes

Rationale (mandatory, including for acceptance):

Response / notes

Decided by

Role Head of Red Team

Signature

Date